

Tata's new hybrid buses, and its Smart Cities initiative

At the launch of its new Starbus Hybrid and Electric production units and the Hydrogen Fuel Cell bus concept, Tata put a lot of emphasis on how it intends to promote smart cities in India. The talk was centered around India's steadily worsening traffic situations, growing concerns on pollution, sustainable means, and the prospect of converting Indian metros into smart cities.

Each of Tata's new buses are equipped with GPS modules that will relay traffic info, along with public Wi-Fi network. Seats will have USB ports installed for charging devices on the go, and Tata has also proposed the making of a transit card - one which will be valid across every mile of your commute.

First mile commutes will be covered by e-bikes and e-rickshaws, taking you to a smart bus depot. These depots are placed in regular intervals, and lead to transit hubs that connect to different districts. The last mile connectivity also works similar to first mile measures. You



will get an app and constant Wi-Fi access to pre-book a bus seat or electric van seat, recharge your transit card, check timings and traffic, pay for all your commutes with one card, and get personalised content services too.

A central traffic management system will monitor the entire public transport system, and all the vehicles in transit will be electric or hybrid, relying on clean energy sources. It is this that Tata is aiming for with its new buses, already having received orders for a fleet of 25 new Tata Starbus Hybrid, and more is expected by it, soon.

India's new tech-laden sports car, the TaMo RaceMo



Tata was the surprising show stopper at the 2017 Geneva Motor Show, with its snazzy new sports car, the TaMo RaceMo. Developed by Tata Motors' new subsidiary, the TaMo RaceMo uses a new, flexible composite material in its Multi-Material Sandwich chassis. The company claims that this will allow faster production time, and its claimed 22-month

development time from scratch for the RaceMo is itself quite impressive for starters.

Shifting focus from its modular designing, the RaceMo is the first car under Tata Motors and Microsoft's connected cars platform. Under this, the RaceMo will present advanced satellite navigation, cloud storage services to backup and store drive statistics and on-road driving details. This will allow predictive maintenance assist, cues to improve car performance and in future, even relay live road info and "talk" to other cars based on the same platform.

Inside, the car has three TFT displays behind the sporty steering wheel, something gamers would relate to. The mid-engine RWD RaceMo is powered by a 3-cylinder, turbocharged 1.2-litre Aluminium intercooled petrol engine. The car is rated to deliver 187 brake horsepower at 6500rpm, and 210Nm of torque at 2500rpm, and has a 6-speed AMT gearbox.

All put together, the RaceMo is a good step ahead for the Indian automobile industry, and a major one for Tata Motors. With TaMo, the Indian carmaker is looking to change its market perspective, and the new RaceMo is aimed for a March 2018 production launch at the India Auto Expo. Safe to say, we are mighty excited for it!